



Figure 2: Heterogeneous cluster of nodes for DevOps

This approach ensures that whenever continuous integration and continuous delivery is completely integrated, it reduces a lot of the time needed for manual software configuration and management activities like build, versioning and deployment, and also reduces time and effort in quality checks (which are automated in continuous delivery). Moreover, the turnaround is quicker when deploying and preparing the test environment along with the latest code releases. A complete discussion on this case study is available online from the Chef official website 'Standard Bank: Our DevOps Journey' at <https://www.chef.io/blog/2015/04/14/standard-bank-our-devops-journey-blog-posts/>

## Summary

In our first article (OSFY, October 2015), we had started with the basic idea of sandbox environment preparation for the Chef environment. In the second article (OSFY, December 2015), we covered the installation and configuration of the Chef server and agents, and synchronised recipes between them. In this article, we have covered cookbook creation, knife tool usage for recipe templates, and a case study on the implementation of Chef in a heterogeneous environment.

The key idea of this series is to introduce readers to ways in which we can use Chef as a CD tool, automate our build/deployment process in an efficient way to improve the standards in delivery management, and reduce the effort/time in build/deployment and quality check process.

Puppet is an alternate to Chef in the world of CD. Though there are a variety of tools available as competitors to Chef, Puppet is one of the most popular and is equally competent as Chef in terms of handling the customer deployment process with a high rate of flexibility. 

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